

Freshman Alumni Bot

A guide for group leaders · @freshmanalumni_bot

How to set it up

Three steps, about a minute.

- 1 Open the group you want the bot working in, and add it as a member: **Members** → **Add member** → @freshmanalumni_bot
- 2 Promote it to **Administrator**, and turn on the **Pin messages** right.
- 3 Message @gapyearingdoesntsuck to say the group is ready. They switch it on, and the bot posts and pins its join announcement there.

Why step 3 isn't automatic.

Being in one of our groups is what qualifies someone for the Alumni group. If adding the bot were enough on its own, anyone could make a group, add it, and let themselves in — so a person with the bot's admin rights confirms each group is really ours.

Nothing happens in your group until they do. If you skip step 3, the bot sits there silently.

Repeat in every group you want covered. Each one is switched on separately and gets its own announcement, so you choose which groups take part and you can add more whenever you like.

Reference

Read once, or only when something looks wrong.

Why Administrator matters

Admin rights are not a formality — the bot is inert without them. Telegram only tells a bot who joins a group if it is an administrator, and pinning needs the **Pin messages** right specifically. If you add the bot as an ordinary member, nothing happens at all: no enrolment, no announcement, no error. **That is the single most common reason a group looks broken.**

Promoting the bot also tells us the group exists, which is why step 3 is just a message rather than anything fiddly — whoever switches it on already sees it in their list and doesn't need an ID or a link from you.

What the bot puts in your group

Exactly two things ever appear in the group chat:

- 1 **The pinned announcement** — two buttons, *Join the Alumni group* and *I'm already in it*. It re-posts itself every five days and deletes the previous one, so only one is ever live.
- 2 **A follow-up message** naming the people who still haven't tapped either button, sent a few days after the announcement.

Everything else is a private DM. Nobody is tagged in the group for not having joined, and nobody is corrected in front of everyone. You can tell your members that safely.

What a member goes through

So you can answer “what is this bot?” without asking us: they tap **Join the Alumni group**, which opens the bot in a private chat. There it asks them to fill in a short form, read the values doc, and send a 50–100 word intro. Once all three are done it hands them a personal one-time invite link and they're admitted automatically. Tapping **I'm already in it** is checked against the real group, so it can't be used to skip the process.

If something looks wrong

Nothing happened at all	Either step 3 hasn't been done yet, or the bot is a member but not an Administrator — it can't post or read the group without that. Check the rights, then message @gapyearingdoesntsuck.
It isn't pinned	The bot has admin rights but not Pin messages . The announcement still works unpinned.
“But I am in the group!”	Almost always a second Telegram account. Ask which account they use in the alumni group, and have them open the bot from that one.
“The bot won't reply to me”	They need to tap Start in the private chat once. Telegram won't let a bot message anyone who hasn't.
Anything else	Message @gapyearingdoesntsuck.

The bot has commands — `/gate_announce`, `/gate_stats`, `/gate_groups`, `/gate_list`, `/gate_unwatch` — but they all check an internal admin list and stay silent for everyone else. There is nothing here for you to run: if one does nothing, ask @gapyearingdoesntsuck rather than retrying.